



September

14

American chopper

The first helicopter with rotor blades to successfully fly took off in Connecticut, USA. Invented and flown by Russian-American aircraft designer Igor Sikorsky, the pioneering VS-300 design was tethered to the ground for its first flight.

1939

Born this day

1973 Nasir bin Olu Dara Jones, Black American rapper and songwriter. Known by his stage name Nas, he has sold more than 25 million records.

1975 Māori march

With the support of 50 followers, Māori leader Whina Cooper (centre right) began the Māori Land March on the North Island of New Zealand to protest against the sale of Māori land. Thousands of people joined Cooper during the month-long march to Parliament in Wellington.



Also on this day

786 Harun al-Rashid took charge as ruler of the Abbasid Caliphate, an Islamic empire that stretched across South Asia, North Africa, and Spain. His reign is considered the start of the Islamic Golden Age.

1814 Inspired by the War of 1812, US lawyer Francis Scott Key wrote a poem, which later became the *Star-Spangled Banner*, the USA's national anthem.



Golden toilet

2019

Thieves stole a fully functioning 18-carat solid gold toilet from Blenheim Palace in Oxfordshire, UK. Named *America*, the unique object was part of an art exhibition where visitors were each allowed three minutes to use the extravagant toilet.